



This 19th-century oil painting depicts the Battle of Las Navas de Tolosa, said to have been the decisive battle of the Reconquista.



A detail from the south gate of the great Khmer city of Angkor Thom.

“ I AM THE PUNISHMENT OF GOD... ”

Genghis Khan, Mongolian warlord



PERSECUTION OF THE CATHARS

Although only 200 Cathars lived in the town of Beziers in Languedoc, Crusaders massacred the entire population in 1209. Asked how the attackers should distinguish between Catholics and heretics, crusade leader Abbot Amaury is reputed to have given his famous order to “kill them all.” In its pursuit of Cathars, the papacy would eventually create the Inquisition (see 1231–35).

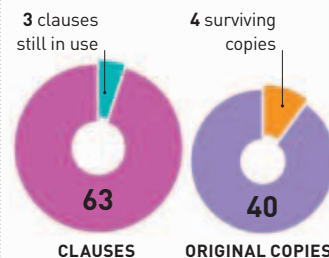
his control, preparing the way for an expansion of royal power.

In 1209, **Cambridge University** was founded by scholars who had relocated from Oxford. By 1226, they had acquired some formal organization.

PETER II OF ARAGON (1178–1213) AND ALFONSO VIII OF CASTILE (1155–1214) defeated the **Almohads** (see 1146–50) at the **Battle of Las Navas de Tolosa** in 1212. Alfonso had earlier been crushingly defeated by the Almohads in 1195 but had fought off invasions by the other **Christian Spanish kingdoms** and rebuilt his army. After this decisive victory, the Almohads were soon expelled from Spain, leaving only local Muslim dynasties that could not stand up to the Christian advance. Accordingly, this battle is traditionally said to be a decisive point in the Christian reconquest or **Reconquista** of Moorish Spain (see 1241–45).

Having lost most of his lands in France, **King John of England** (1166–1216) joined in alliance with Emperor Otto IV (1178–1215) and others, but they were crushed at the **Battle of Bouvines** in Flanders in 1214 by Philip II of France and the rival German emperor, Frederick II. This ended Anglo-Norman hopes of regaining French territories. King John's barons were forced to concentrate on England, where they had cause for discontent. Thanks to a dispute with the pope, the king had been briefly **excommunicated**. More importantly, he was taxing the barons heavily and invalidating the

law when it suited him. The **barons revolted** and after a brief civil war, John was forced to sign the Articles of the Barons, known in history as the Great Charter or **Magna Carta**. Although this mainly concerned the rights of barons, its statement that the king was not above the law was an important milestone for human rights. King John immediately disowned the charter, and war



The Magna Carta

Of the 63 clauses contained in the original Magna Carta, only three survive as laws today. Numerous copies were made, to be distributed around England; four survive.

broke out once more, this time with added French involvement. Retreating from a French invasion force in 1216, the king lost his baggage train—and his royal treasure—while crossing the Wash in Lincolnshire, England, and died soon after. His infant son, Henry III (1207–72) came to the throne.

26 FEET THE HEIGHT OF THE WALLS OF ANGKOR THOM

JAYAVARMAN VII DIED IN AROUND 1220

having seen his greatest creation take shape. At Angkor, in modern-day Cambodia, he created a new city, Angkor Thom, centered on the great temple of Bayon. The temple comprises towers decorated with huge sculpted faces; the identities of these are disputed, although they may include Jayavarman himself.

Having conquered most of Central Asia and northern China, Genghis Khan's empire (see 1201–05) now bordered the Khwarazm Empire of Persia.

Mongolian dagger

The Mongolians had a deservedly fearsome reputation. After archers had decimated the enemy, fighters with hand weapons would close in.

DOMINGO DE GUZMAN, A CASTILIAN CLERIC, DIED IN 1221. In 1203, he had gone to Rome to ask permission to do missionary work with the Tartars (see 1201–10), but was sent to France to preach to the **Cathars of Languedoc** instead. By adopting absolute poverty, he was able to **challenge the Cathars** and make some headway, although ultimately his failure to “correct” the heretics led to the Albigensian Crusade (see 1206–10). However, like Francis of Assisi (see 1226–30), he had created a new kind of monastic order—the Dominicans—adapted to the new urban culture. The **Dominicans** and **Franciscans** were mendicant friars, mainly recruited from the middle classes, living off charity rather than farming, and devoted to preaching and charity in towns and cities.

A largely ineffective affair, the **Fifth Crusade** was the fruit of Pope Innocent's determination to reboot the Crusading movement. Targeting Egypt, the Crusaders took that but then lost Damiatta, and failed to account for the Nile floods, which foiled their advance on Cairo. They high-handedly rejected a treaty offered by the sultan that would have given them Jerusalem, and left Egypt in 1221 having accomplished nothing.



1209 Founding of Cambridge University, England

1209 Otto IV elected Emperor

1209 Francis of Assisi establishes Franciscans, Catholic religious order

1210 Hindu rebellions against Sultanate of Delhi, India

1211 Genghis Khan conquers Kara-Khitai, Central Asia and invades Jin China

1211 Civil strife in Germany as Frederick II elected rival emperor to Otto IV

1212 Battle of Las Navas de Tolosa, Spain

1214 Philip II and Frederick II defeat anti-Capetian alliance at Battle of Bouvines, France

1215 Magna Carta signed following civil war in England

1215 Fourth Lateran Council calls halt to Albigensian Crusade and calls for a Fifth Crusade to Egypt

1215 Genghis Khan takes Beijing, China

1216 Death of King John of England (b. 1166)

1218 Death of Jayavarman VII (b. 1125)

1218 Genghis Khan invades Khwarazmid Empire, Western Asia

1219 Shokyu War in Japan withdraws from Champa, Southeast Asia

1220 Khmer Empire withdraws from Champa, Southeast Asia

1221 Fifth Crusade ends with loss of Damiatta and retreat

1221 Death of St. Dominic (b. 1170), founder of the Dominicans

1221 Genghis Khan sacks Samarkand

1221 Toltecs expelled from Chichen Itza, Mexico

1222 Icelandic scholar Snorri Sturluson writes Edda, a book of Nordic mythology